

Lightforth — Escalation Procedures

Overview

When and how to escalate during a sales or support conversation. Escalating fast is a tool to save the customer, not a sign of failure.

When to Escalate

Refund Requests Outside Policy

Trigger: Customer asks for a refund past the 14-day window, or wants an exception to standard policy
Escalate to: Support Lead **Timeline:** Within 24 hours

Discount Requests

Trigger: Any discount beyond what's self-serve (student/referral/annual) **Escalate to:** Sales Lead (bundles under 20 seats) or Founder/CVO (20+ seats, or any exception request) **Timeline:** 24-48 hours — see [knowledge-center/04-discount-guidelines.md](#)

Live-Interview-Blocking Bug

Trigger: A customer reports Copilot failing to work *during or immediately before* a real scheduled interview
Escalate to: Support Lead, treat as urgent **Timeline:** Immediately — this is the single highest-stakes support scenario in the product

At-Risk / Upset Customer

Trigger: Customer expressing strong dissatisfaction or threatening to cancel and post publicly **Escalate to:** Support Lead **Timeline:** Within 4 hours

Billing Disputes

Trigger: Customer disputes a charge or requests a refund outside standard policy **Escalate to:** Support Lead + Finance **Timeline:** Within 24 hours

Bundle / Organization Issues

Trigger: Seat provisioning errors, an organization disputing invoiced seat counts, or a coach reporting low cohort adoption **Escalate to:** Sales Lead **Timeline:** Within 24 hours

Escalation Process

Step 1: Document the Situation

- Customer email/account
- What happened, in their words
- What's been tried so far
- Requested outcome

Step 2: Choose the Right Path

Situation	Escalate To	Timeline
Refund outside policy	Support Lead	24 hours
Discount request	Sales Lead / Founder	24-48 hours
Live-interview-blocking bug	Support Lead	Immediately
At-risk/upset customer	Support Lead	4 hours
Billing dispute	Support Lead + Finance	24 hours
Bundle/organization issue	Sales Lead	24 hours

Step 3: Follow Up

- Update the customer with a clear timeline, even if the answer isn't final yet
- Document the outcome for future reference

Escalation Email Template

Subject: Escalation: [Customer email] – [Brief issue]

Hi [Name],

Need a hand with this one:

Customer: [Email]

Issue: [What happened]

Tried so far: [Actions taken]

Requested outcome: [What they want]

Urgency: [Normal / Same-day / Immediate – live interview affected]

Can you take a look today?

Thanks,

[Your Name]

Best Practices

- **Escalate live-interview-blocking issues immediately** — nothing else in this product is this time-sensitive
- **Document before escalating** — don't make someone re-ask the customer what already happened
- **Always follow up with the customer**, even just to say it's being looked at
- **Learn from it** — note the resolution so the same issue is faster to handle next time

Last updated: July 2026 Confidential — Lightforth Sales Team Only